(11/6)

In the last two weeks, there have been developments with Valley Village and the literature review.

Firstly, I have started drafting my literature review, tackling different sections and aspects in chunks, having spent some time with the synthesis of my research, now it is in the process of being formatted and identified through writing. I have written a general overview of the project, and stated the goals and objectives of my capstone project and how the literature review fits into it. I also made a truncated version of a personal glossary for terminology that I found in my research, which should help readers when I use more specific terms, whether technology-based, gerontology-based, or phraseology that holds specific meanings in the context of the research. Alongside this glossary, I decided to include some writing about the essence of the term "technology," and the struggle to define it. That I will include here, because I believe it has merit to show:

> This literature review will consistently use the term "technology" in a fluid manner that lacks strict definitive rigor. The term is perhaps entirely undefinable, and often falls within specific descriptive patterns depending on the topics of research that it is being spoken about. Today, there is virtually no distinction between "technology," and "internet technology" in a way that might not have been true prior to the widespread adoption of the Internet. Because understanding the intersection of technology and its elderly users is the express goal of this literature review, this undefinable term could lead to conclusions and generalizations that lack rigor. Clarity is important given the term, and will consistently be specified what "technology" means in given contexts. That is because "technology" is often contextualized, and generally defined, by its usage. Devices like cell phones, applications, or functionalities like copy & paste can be understood as "technology," given the context of its description. As this literature review is attempting to contextualize the struggles with technology that elders face, these contexts will center the issues and frustrations that are experienced in usage of technology, and what "technology" is a barrier towards adoption.

This illustrates some of the thinking that I have had around "technology" and how it fits into this capstone project. I am now in the process of speaking on various barriers of adoption, and the other aspects of the research that I outlined in the previous reflection (10/23).

I have now had two technology help sessions at Valley Village. In addition to these reflection posts, I will be posting a summary of my notes and experiences throughout these sessions, along with some initial reflections about the individual interactions. Currently, I need to ascertain how this research will present itself in formalized writing, or as a product to some extent to illustrate my findings. Having no previous experience with doing qualitative research, I am wondering how I can format these notes and reflections, beyond simple introspective writing that I feel isn't truly reflective of research. As these tech help sessions continue, I will work towards generalizing some apparent truths, and see how I can facilitate a group discussion or workshop working on these issues. Based on what I learn from these two experiences, I will begin designing and creating the final product for this capstone project. My goal for the next two weeks is to finish the draft of my literature review, and have a few more technology help sessions at Valley Village, from which I can then create a list of general struggles that can be practically tackled in the near future. Moreover, I will be spending some time working with the Townshend library folks in the next two weeks, although my attempt to reach out somewhat recently fell flat. I intend to contact them once more and find a time to meet about their Tech Hour programming.